

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1257

By Carringer

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of John Peden Valliant, Jr.,
of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of John Peden Valliant, Jr., of Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, John Valliant was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Valliant was born in 1947 in Oak Ridge and graduated from Oak Ridge High School before pursuing higher education at the University of Tennessee Law School; and

WHEREAS, John Valliant's passion for justice and advocacy led him to a distinguished legal career in Knoxville spanning five decades; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his professional accomplishments, Mr. Valliant was deeply involved in civic life and served as the chairman of the Knox County Democratic Party in 1982; and

WHEREAS, John Valliant served in the U.S. Army National Guard during the Vietnam War era; and

WHEREAS, his larger-than-life personality left a lasting mark on those who knew him; Mr. Valliant was known for his colorful disposition, and it was once said that he would "kick a bear in the rear just to see what would happen"; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Mr. Valliant always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, John Valliant is survived by his wife of thirty-five years, Judy Carol Williams Valliant; daughter, Katherine Sullivan Valliant; son, John Peden Valliant III; and daughter-in-law, Jane Romano Valliant; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Valliant leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of John Peden Valliant, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Valliant.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.